

Canadian Gov./ Economics





About the Course

Students will spend the first two terms on the history and structure of Canada's constitutional monarchy and on the Charter of Rights and Freedoms. They will then end the year with an introduction to economics, focusing on the history of money, the banking system, and personal finance.

This topic is included in the following course(s): Citizenship: Grade 8 (Canada)



Placement & Combining Tips

The book *Canada's Constitutional Monarchy* will be read over two years (Grades 8 and 9). However, since this is the first year this book will be introduced, Grades 8 and 9 will have the same readings in 2026-2027.

If a student hasn't studied Canada's government yet, consider having them take the Grade 7 government course first.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
8	Canadian Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 1 time/week 25 min	Dollars and Sense: A Kid's Guide to Using - Not Losing - Money Canada's Constitutional Monarchy

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Citizenship: Grade 8 (Canada)				
Ethics: Part 2 Community Read Alouds: Grades 1-12		Canadian Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 Current Events: Grades 5-8		Plutarch: Grades 6-8



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

Citizenship: Grade 8 (Canada)

☐ Make sure your student sets up a Citizenship Notebook. They will need a 3-ring binder, lined notebook paper, and 5 Tabbed Dividers. You can read more about how to set one up and suggestions for various sections in the document in Quick Links.

☐ As desired, plan for a read-aloud time. Suggestions are provided in the Community Read Aloud Quick Link, but local favorites are highly recommended whenever possible.

☐ Make a Calendar of Events for Current Events lessons by drawing a calendar grid in a notebook (or print a blank calendar from the internet).

Term Prep & Teacher Tips

Canadian Gov./ Economics: Grade 8

In Term 2, students will be asked to do online research about their own local municipal, provincial, and federal elected officials. These assignments should be done with parental supervision to ensure internet safety.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

Canadian Gov./ Economics: Grade 8



Dollars and Sense: A Kid's Guide to Using - Not Losing - Money



Canada's Constitutional Monarchy



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

Related Course Quick Links

- ∞ [Extra Helpings](#)
- ∞ [Community Read Alouds](#)
- ∞ [Setting Up a Citizenship Notebook](#)

Click THIS text
or scan the QR
code for links.



Canadian Gov./ Economics: Grade 8

How To Teach



Prepare

Plutarch: Teachers will find it helpful to preread the entire Life first, and then preread the day's passage before each lesson. Mark any passages that should be omitted due to content. (In Anne White's Plutarch Project books, the recommended source for this course, objectionable content has already been omitted.)

Current Events: Preview the news source for suitability.

Most other citizenship topics don't require additional prep.



Recap

Connect back to the previous lesson. (Optional for Current Events).



Introduce

For news sources, show students how to scan the headlines to get an overview first and then choose a story to read.

For Plutarch or other books: Use a picture, a map, or an engaging question to prepare students to receive the story as relevant. You may talk about one or two unfamiliar words that will be crucial to understanding. It is not necessary to cover all unfamiliar words.



Read

Read the selection assigned or the news story chosen. For rich, dense, or more challenging books such as *Ourselves* and *Plutarch*, it is a good idea to read them aloud. Have students keep an eye out for things to add to their Citizenship Notebook, *Book of Centuries*, and/or *Commonplace book*.



Narrate

Have the students narrate orally or in writing.



Discuss

Give students an opportunity to share their thoughts on the story and any connections made. For current events, look up where events occurred on a map and ask questions to help students discern the quality of the piece. (e.g., Are there sources cited? Is there an obvious bias? If so, what do other authors have to say on this subject? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?) Consider reading an alternative perspective.



Citizenship Notebook

Have students record important ideas in their Citizenship Notebooks.

Canadian Gov./ Economics: Grade 8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 1 25m Canadian Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 1

Introduction

Materials: Canada's Constitutional Monarchy

→ INTRO

Who is in charge in Canada? Is it the Prime Minister? Parliament? The Monarch? The Governor General? Canada is a constitutional monarchy and a parliamentary democracy—what do these two phrases mean, and how do they work together? Before starting your reading for today, spend a few minutes writing down or discussing with someone what you know about Canada's government and how you would answer these questions.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.15-22 "Canada is a blended family" - "where they came from."

- Why does the author talk about the institution of the Crown rather than the person of the king (or queen) when discussing the Monarch's role in Canada?
- What prompted the author to write this book?

★ TEACHER TIP

This book was written before the death of Queen Elizabeth II in 2022, so any reference to her in the book now refers to King Charles III.

Canada's Constitutional Monarchy is read over two years: half in Grade 8, and the other half in Grade 9. Since this is the first year the Alveary is including this book, both grades read the first half of the book together in 2026-2027.

WEEK 2 25m Canadian Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 2

The History of the Crown in Canada

Materials: Canada's Constitutional Monarchy

→ RECAP

What do you recall from yesterday's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.23-30 "There was a reason" - "died from disease."

- Why can Senator Eugene Forsey say that "No part of this country has ever been a republic or part of a republic"? How is Canada not a republic?

→ NOTEBOOK

Select some notable dates from today's reading and add them to your Timeline or Book of Centuries.

• DEFINITIONS

republic: a form of government in which the power belongs to a body of citizens entitled to vote and is exercised by the leaders and representatives elected by those citizens to govern according to law.

WEEK 3 25m Canadian Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 3

The History of the Crown in Canada, cont.

Materials: Canada's Constitutional Monarchy

→ RECAP

What do you recall from yesterday's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.30-38 "Founded on Mi'kmaq land" - "locally elected legislature."

- Describe "responsible government" in your own words. How is it "the uniquely Canadian solution to balancing American republicanism with British monarchy?"

→ NOTEBOOK

Select some notable dates from today's reading and add them to your Timeline or Book of Centuries.

Canadian Gov./ Economics: Grade 8

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Term 1

WEEK 4 25m Canadian Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 4

The History of the Crown in Canada, cont.

Materials: Canada's Constitutional Monarchy

→ RECAP

What do you recall from yesterday's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.39-47 "In an effort to secure" - "a province of Canada in 1949."

- What do you think of the name 'Dominion of Canada' that was selected in 1867?
- Explain the role of the lieutenant governor. How did the ruling in 1892 clarify and solidify the position of lieutenant governor?

→ NOTEBOOK

Select some notable dates from today's reading and add them to your Timeline or Book of Centuries.

WEEK 5 25m Canadian Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 5

The History of the Crown in Canada, cont.

Materials: Canada's Constitutional Monarchy

→ RECAP

What do you recall from yesterday's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.48-53 "During his coronation" - "the Sovereign they represent."

- What were some of the changes or modifications to Canada's relationship with the Crown that occurred in the twentieth century?

→ NOTEBOOK

Select some notable dates from today's reading and add them to your Timeline or Book of Centuries.

WEEK 6 25m Canadian Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 6

The Canadian Constitution and Authority

Materials: Canada's Constitutional Monarchy

→ RECAP

What do you recall from yesterday's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.54-61 "Government is a structure" - "worked on the design."

- What are some of the components that make up the Canadian constitution?
- Why do Cabinet ministers make oaths to the Monarch, and not to Canadian citizens, or the Constitution, or to any other aspect of government? What does this say about power, authority, and legitimacy?

• DEFINITIONS

common law: a body of law created by judges through their written decisions rather than through statutes passed by legislative bodies.

ministerial responsibility: a constitutional convention in parliamentary systems dictating that Cabinet ministers are accountable to Parliament for the actions, policies, and administration of their respective departments.

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[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 7 25m Canadian Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 7

The Canadian Constitution and Authority

Materials: Canada's Constitutional Monarchy

→ RECAP

What do you recall from yesterday's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.62-69 "Badge of the Senate" - "fixed point in our democracy."

- Why is it significant that the official title of the leader of the Opposition is "Leader of His Majesty's Loyal Opposition"? Who is he or she loyal to?
- How is the Crown like a fire extinguisher?

WEEK 8 25m Canadian Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 8

The Queen of Canada

Materials: Canada's Constitutional Monarchy

→ RECAP

What do you recall from yesterday's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.70-77 "The Canadian Oath of Citizenship" - "acting out our traditions is so important."

- Explain how the Crown is a symbol and a personification.
- Why are ceremonies so important?

• COMPOSITION

Come up with and explain another metaphor or simile describing the relationship between the Crown and Canada.

WEEK 9 25m Canadian Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 9

The Queen of Canada, cont.; The Governor General and the National Crown

Materials: Canada's Constitutional Monarchy

→ RECAP

What do you recall from yesterday's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.77-85 "The ancient ceremony" - "Canadian Grenadier Guards."

- What does it mean for the Canadian Crown to be called a "Compound Monarchy"?
- What are some of the roles of the Governor General?

→ VIEW

Watch the Black Rod ceremony from the King's Throne Speech to open Parliament in 2025.

∞ Video Link: The Usher of the Black Rod calls MPs to the Senate Chamber for the Throne Speech

WEEK 10 25m Canadian Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 10

The Governor General and the National Crown, cont.

Materials: Canada's Constitutional Monarchy

→ RECAP

What do you recall from yesterday's reading?

Canadian Gov./ Economics: Grade 8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.86-93 "Over the years" - "Queen of Canada, 1980."

- What other roles does the Governor General play?
- Who is our current Governor General? Look up the biography on the Governor General's website.
- ∞ Link: The Governor General of Canada

→ VIEW

Take a tour of the Governor General's residence.

∞ Image Link: La Citadelle

WEEK 11 25m Canadian Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 11

The Lieutenant Governors and the Provincial Crowns

Materials: Canada's Constitutional Monarchy

→ RECAP

What do you recall from yesterday's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.94-102 "As provincial representatives" - "lieutenant governor of Nova Scotia."

- What is the relationship between the Crown and the Lieutenant Governor?
- What are some of the roles and responsibilities of the Lieutenant Governor?
- Who is the current Lieutenant Governor of your province or territory?

WEEK 12 25m Canadian Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 12

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:

Canada's Constitutional Monarchy

Canadian Gov./ Economics: Grade 8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

WEEK 1 25m Canadian Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 13

Officers and Officials of the Crown

Materials: Canada's Constitutional Monarchy

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.240-248 "An honorary position" - "recommendation of the prime minister."

- Which positions and roles were new to you?

WEEK 2 25m Canadian Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 14

→ READ & NARRATE

Find a current events article about your government. Narrate your chosen article either orally or in writing.

WEEK 3 25m Canadian Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 15

Did You Know?

Materials: Canada's Constitutional Monarchy

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.207-216 "The Queen made her first" - "Protestant and Roman Catholic."

- Which facts or events were most interesting to you?

WEEK 4 25m Canadian Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 16

Did You Know?, cont.

Materials: Canada's Constitutional Monarchy

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.217-232 "The Victorian Order of Nurses" - "as it comes available."

- Which facts or events were more interesting to you?

WEEK 5 25m Canadian Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 17

→ READ & NARRATE

Find a current events article about your government. Narrate your chosen article either orally or in writing.

WEEK 6 25m Canadian Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 18

→ EXPLORE

See Parliament in action by watching an excerpt from a recent House of Commons or Senate Proceedings or Question Period.

∞ Video Link: House of Commons Video Archive

∞ Video Link: Senate Video Archive

Canadian Gov./ Economics: Grade 8

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Term 2

WEEK 7 25m Canadian Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 19

→ READ & NARRATE

Find a current events article about your government. Narrate your chosen article either orally or in writing.

WEEK 8 25m Canadian Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 20

Charter of Rights and Freedoms

Materials: Canadian Charter of Rights and Freedoms (PDF)

→ INTRO

Last year, if you studied Grade 7 Canadian Government, you read about the Canadian Charter of Rights and Freedoms. Over the next three weeks, you are going to read the full text of the Charter yourself.

→ READ

∞ PDF Link: Canadian Charter of Rights and Freedoms (PDF)

From "Whereas Canada is founded" - "employment in Canada."

(Optional) If you'd like more clarification about any points, consult the following link:

∞ Link: Guide to the Canadian Charter of Rights and Freedoms

→ NARRATE

This reading is very short, but there's a lot to think about! As you read through the charter, make one list of rights and one list of freedoms. Look at what you wrote down today. How do these rights and freedoms affect your life right now?

★ TEACHER NOTE

Students could review

∞ **Article Link:** How Canadians Govern Themselves, p.15-16

WEEK 9 25m Canadian Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 21

Charter of Rights and Freedoms, cont.

Materials: Canadian Charter of Rights and Freedoms (PDF)

→ RECAP

What rights and freedoms did you read about last time?

→ READ

∞ PDF Link: Canadian Charter of Rights and Freedoms (PDF)

From "Everyone has the right" - "out of public funds."

(Optional) If you'd like more clarification about any points, consult the following link:

∞ Link: Guide to the Canadian Charter of Rights and Freedoms

→ NARRATE

Continue adding to your list of rights and list of freedoms. Look at what you wrote down today. How do these rights and freedoms affect your life right now?

WEEK 10 25m Canadian Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 22

Charter of Rights and Freedoms, cont.

Materials: Canadian Charter of Rights and Freedoms (PDF)

→ RECAP

What rights and freedoms did you read about last time?

→ READ

∞ PDF Link: Canadian Charter of Rights and Freedoms (PDF)

From "Anyone whose rights" - "such immeasurable joy."

(Optional) If you'd like more clarification about any points, consult the

Term 2	
following link: ∞ Link: Guide to the Canadian Charter of Rights and Freedoms → NARRATE Continue adding to your list of rights and list of freedoms. Look at what you wrote down today. How do these rights and freedoms affect your life right now? → EXPLORE Test your knowledge of the practical application of the rights and freedoms found in the Charter with the following two activities: ∞ Link: Understanding Rights and Freedoms ∞ Link: Rights and Responsibilities in the Community	
WEEK 11 25m Canadian Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 23 → READ & NARRATE Find a current events article about your government. Narrate your chosen article either orally or in writing. → CATCH-UP Use this time to catch up on lessons in this or another course, update your Timeline or Book of Centuries, or explore Extra Helpings.	
WEEK 12 25m Canadian Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 24 Exam Week → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: Charter of Rights and Freedoms	

Canadian Gov./ Economics: Grade 8

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Term 3

WEEK 1 25m Canadian Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 25

Materials: Dollars & Sense

→ INTRO

Are you familiar with the Bible verse, "The love of money is a root of all kinds of evil" (1 Timothy 6:10)? What do you think that means, and how have you seen that truth play out? This term, we will be studying economics, which has to do with money and the way a country uses and produces goods and services.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Introduction ix-xiii "Bread, Dough." - "dollars and cents."

Also, go to Ch.1 and read the section at the bottom of p.8 "You've Got It and I Want It: The Law of Supply and Demand."

- How does money help the economy, and how does greed hurt the economy?
- Explain the economic principle "The Law of Supply and Demand."
- ∞ Video Link: What is Supply and Demand?

→ CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

Make a list of the goods and services your family uses that contribute to a healthy economy. Goods are tangible things you buy, such as clothes and food. Services are intangible and usually involve paying for a business to do something for you. Examples: haircuts, car insurance, phone service.

Can you think of examples that fit this economic principle? Also, make a list of items that may be in high demand or low demand depending on the time of year.

WEEK 2 25m Canadian Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 26

Materials: Dollars & Sense

→ RECAP

What do you remember about last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.1 Skulls, Sheep, and Shells p.1-9 "Have you ever" - "the ancient world."

- Why did the bartering system need to be replaced with something better?
- Talk about the different items used before money and why they didn't work out.

→ CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

Make a timeline and draw pictures with labels to show the different mediums of exchange from ancient times to the present day. Look at p.4-5 to help you fill out the timeline. There are links to see some of the different mediums that were used.

→ VIEW

- ∞ Image Link: Cowrie shells used as money in ancient China
- ∞ Image Link: Deerskin used as folding money (China)
- ∞ Image Link: Chinese paper money
- ∞ Image Link: Fort Knox

Canadian Gov./ Economics: Grade 8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

WEEK 3 25m Canadian Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 27

Materials: Dollars & Sense, Historical Atlas of the World

→ RECAP

What do you remember about last week's reading?

→ LOCATE

Using the Historical Atlas of the World p.8, find Mesopotamia and Babylon. What present-day countries are located there?

Go to p.30-31, find Jerusalem, Edessa, Antioch, and Tripoli. Now, find Florence, Italy. These are places that we will read about today that have to do with an early form of banking.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.2 Worry, Worry, Worry! p.11-19 "Where do you keep" - "Hard work." (Also read sections on p.12 "An Eye for an Eye" and p.14 "You Can't Take it With You.")

- What banking practices from history are still used today?
- How did the Knights Templar help the Pilgrims while traveling to Jerusalem?

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link: Knights Templar

• IMPORTANT DATES

Founding of the order the Knights Templar (1119 AD)

WEEK 4 25m Canadian Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 28

Materials: Dollars & Sense

→ RECAP

What do you remember about last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.3 New Money for a New Nation p.21- 29 "In early America" - "finally in place." (Also, go back and read the section about Alexander Hamilton on p.22.)

- What were some reasons some people were opposed to a national bank?

→ VIEW & DISCUSS

Look at the map on p.27, which shows the location of Federal Reserve Banks. What bank is your city part of? You can check out this link to see the 12 districts.

∞ Image Link: The Twelve Federal Reserve Districts

→ CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

Make a chart showing the information on p.28. You can look at these websites to find additional information, such as the names of the people in charge of the different areas.

∞ Link: Federal Reserve Board

∞ Link: Comptroller of the Currency

★ TEACHER NOTE

This lesson is less relevant for Canadians, so students have three options:

1. Do the lesson as written to learn more about the history of the United States.
2. Read about the history of the Bank of Canada.
∞ **Article Link:** History of the Bank of Canada
3. Use today's class as a Catch-Up day.

• EXTRA HELPING

Watch this 3-minute video on this website that explains the purpose of the Federal Reserve System.

∞ **Video Link:** Federal Reserve System

• IMPORTANT DATES

Establishment of the first national bank of the United States (1791)
The Federal Reserve Banks were established (1913)

WEEK 5 25m Canadian Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 29

Materials: Dollars & Sense

PREP: Print out the check template and check register.

∞ Link: Check template

Canadian Gov./ Economics: Grade 8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

∞ Link: Check register

→ RECAP

What do you remember about last week's reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.4 Money Comes In and Money Goes Out p.31-41 "Money and power" - "always that way."

- What happens when you write a check for more than you have in your bank account?

→ VIEW & DISCUSS

Explain the graph on p.39. It is based on the idea that you have \$1000 in a savings account.

→ CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

Fill out the check template and check register (bank book) and put it in your notebook.

Make a list of the types of bank accounts and briefly describe each one. See p.40 for more information.

WEEK 6 25m Canadian Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 30

📄 Materials: Dollars & Sense

→ RECAP

What did you read last time in economics?

→ INTRO

Are you familiar with the stock market? What do you know about it? First, read the section on p.45 "Companies for Sale" to prepare for the reading.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.5 Money Goes Away p.44-49 "Inflation. Recession." - "had to be done."

- Describe some of the events that led to the Great Depression.

• IMPORTANT DATES

The Stock Market Crash (1929)

WEEK 7 25m Canadian Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 31

📄 Materials: Dollars & Sense

→ RECAP

What did you read last time in economics?

→ INTRO

What do you think it would be like to become the President in the middle of the Great Depression?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.5 Money Goes Away p.49-53 "Franklin Delano Roosevelt" - "the Great Recession."

→ NOTE

You don't need to read the excerpt "Thinking about Money" on p.52. It will be read in the next lesson.

- What are some things that President Roosevelt did to help the economy? Why did some people not agree with those actions?

• EXTRA HELPING

You can look to see what public works were created in your state as a result of the New Deal, which employed thousands of people.

∞ Link: New Deal projects by state

• IMPORTANT DATES

New Deal programs are established by FDR (1933)

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Term 3

→ CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

Make a list of some of the economic programs that were part of the New Deal. You can find the information on p.53 and at the following website.
∞ Link: New Deal Programs

WEEK 8 25m Canadian Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 32

Materials: Dollars & Sense

→ RECAP

What did you read last time in economics?

→ INTRO

Do you know what a mortgage is? How does it help people buy houses?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.6 Money Shrinks p.55-61 "Most people " - "in the future."

- Explain what we mean by a housing bubble and how that was one of the factors that led to the Great Recession.

On p.61, the author writes, "Once again, Keynesian economics came into play as the US government stepped in to institute large and controversial programs."

- Go back to p.52 and read the excerpt about the famous economist John Maynard Keynes. Discuss his theories and how they came into play during the Great Recession.

→ CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

Make a list of the ways the government stepped in to stimulate the economy during the Great Recession. You can find information in the excerpts on p.60-61.

• IMPORTANT DATES

Great Recession (December 2007-June 2009)

WEEK 9 25m Canadian Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 33

Materials: Dollars & Sense

→ RECAP

What did you read last time in economics?

→ INTRO

What would life be like if everyone only bought things they could afford in cash? How could that be a good thing? How could that be a negative thing? What items might be hard to purchase?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.7 Can I Borrow Some Money? p.63-71 "In the first" - "in the future."

- What are the pros and cons of using credit cards?
- What factors affect one's credit score?

→ CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

Make a list of the different kinds of real estate loans and include a brief description of each.

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Term 3

WEEK 10 25m Canadian Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 34

Materials: Dollars & Sense

→ RECAP

What did you read last time in Economics?

→ INTRO

Why do you think having a budget is a wise financial practice?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.8 Where Did My Money Go? p.73-76 "Money is" - "paying the bills."

- What is the difference between needs and wants, and how does that affect a budget?
- Many people suggest three categories for budgeting—spending, saving, and giving. What do you think about those 3 categories, and how can you go about implementing that?

→ CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

Practice putting together a budget. Use the example on p.74 and create a chart in your notebook. If you don't have your own money or expenses, you can try to put one together to show the expenses of an average household and see what kind of income you would need to cover those expenses.

WEEK 11 25m Canadian Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 35

Materials: Dollars & Sense

→ RECAP

What did you read last time in Economics?

→ INTRO

Do you know how much debt the U.S. has? Take a guess. You can find the answer on this website:

∞ Link: National Debt

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.8 Where Did My Money Go? p.77-86, Also read excerpts on p.78, 82. Conclusion, p.85-86 "It's not just" - "no matter what."

- Why do you think it is so hard to balance the national budget?

→ CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK

Make a list of some of the items that the federal government spends money on. Make a list of ways the government receives money (revenue). Try to brainstorm by yourself, and then you can use these websites to find more information.

∞ Link: Government Spending

∞ Link: Federal Revenue

WEEK 12 25m Canadian Gov./ Economics: Grade 8 - Lesson 36

Materials: Dollars & Sense

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Canadian Gov./ Economics: Grade 8

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Term 3

Questions will come from:
Dollars & Sense

Canadian Gov./ Economics: Grade 8

Examination

Term 1

· Canada's Constitutional Monarchy: The author, Nathan Tidridge, uses a number of metaphors and similes to explain the relationship between the Crown and Canada: a blended family, a fire extinguisher, a car and its owner. Choose one from this list (or another from the reading this term) and explain the comparison. OR Explain the balance of power that exists between the Crown, the Prime Minister, and Parliament. What does it mean that the prime minister's power is "borrowed"?

Term 2

· Charter of Rights and Freedoms: List as many rights and freedoms contained in the Charter as you can and provide some concrete examples of how they do (or could) affect your daily life.

Term 3

· Dollars & Sense: Tell what you know about the formation of the national banking system. OR Tell what you know about the services banks offer.